

EIC SCHOOL · ADULT B2+ · PART 2 OF 2

The Way Back

Causative verbs & passive voice · Question formation

What psychology and philosophy have learned about reclaiming attention, desire, and a life that feels chosen.

Student

Date

THE TEXT

The first thing the psychologists say is the hardest to accept: you cannot **make the system disappear** [*make + bare inf.*] by deciding to ignore it. Willpower, as a strategy, **has been studied** [*present perfect passive*] exhaustively, and the conclusion is consistent: it depletes. The person who **makes herself resist** [*make + bare inf.*] the phone at 8am will reach for it at 8pm with twice the urgency. Resistance, without something to replace it, is just deferred consumption.

What ACT proposes instead is a shift in relationship — not with the system, but with your own responses to it. You are not asked to stop noticing the pull of the feed. You are asked to notice that you are noticing it. This small gap — between stimulus and response — is where, according to Viktor Frankl, human freedom actually lives. **Letting the thought exist** [*let + bare inf.*] without acting on it is not weakness. It is the beginning of psychological flexibility.

Csikszentmihalyi arrived at a similar conclusion from a different direction. He found that the moments people reported as most meaningful **were not produced by consumption** [*simple past passive*] but by flow states — moments of complete absorption in a task. The system, by design, **makes flow nearly impossible** [*make + bare inf.*]: it interrupts before depth can develop, rewards the surface, and **gets you to mistake stimulation for satisfaction** [*get + to + inf.*].

Simone Weil called the capacity for sustained attention the highest form of human generosity. To truly attend to something — a person, a problem, a piece of music — **a kind of self-emptying is required** [*present simple passive*]. You must **let yourself be fully affected** [*let + bare inf.*] by what is in front of you. The system **makes this almost impossible** [*make + bare inf.*] — every notification is a reminder that you exist, that you have preferences, that the world is waiting for your reaction.

None of this means the solution is simple, or that it **can be implemented** [*modal passive*] through a weekend retreat. What **gets people to change** [*get + to + inf.*] sustainably is a clarification of what they actually value when the system is not **making that choice for them** [*make + for + person*]. The question is not how do I use my phone less. The question is: what do I actually want — when nothing is **making me want it** [*make + bare inf.*]?

CAUSATIVE QUESTIONS

- 1 According to psychologists, you cannot make the system _____ (*do what*) by deciding to ignore it.

- 2 ACT teaches you to _____ (*let what happen*) without acting on it.
- 3 The system _____ (*makes what*) nearly impossible — it interrupts before depth can develop.
- 4 The system gets you _____ (*do what*) — confusing stimulation with fulfilment.
- 5 According to Weil, you must _____ (*let yourself do what*) by what is in front of you.
- 6 Sustainable change happens when the system is no longer _____ (*making what*) for you.
- 7 The final question: what do you actually want when nothing is _____ (*making you do what*)?

PASSIVE VOICE QUESTIONS

- 1 Willpower, as a strategy, _____ (*what has happened to it*) exhaustively.
- 2 Csikszentmihalyi found that meaningful moments _____ (*what happened to them*) not by consumption.
- 3 To truly attend to something, _____ (*what*) is required.
- 4 The solution is not simple, and it _____ (*what cannot happen*) through a weekend retreat.